

Here are 5 key ways you can use these credits:

1. Web Hosting (Azure App Service)

You can use credits to host your company website or professional web applications. Instead of paying a monthly fee to a traditional web host, Azure App Service handles the servers for you. It is designed to scale, meaning your site stays fast even if many clients access your safety reports or marketing content at the same time.

2. Custom Domains & DNS

While credits typically cover the hosting of a site, Azure also allows you to manage your professional web address (e.g., www.reginaldsherq.co.za).

Note: Credits usually apply to the DNS Zone (the system that directs traffic to your site) and the App Service hosting. Direct domain registration (buying the name itself) often requires a separate payment, but the credits cover the ongoing technical costs of keeping that domain linked to your services.

3. Professional Databases (Azure SQL)

Instead of keeping client data or safety records in Excel files that can be lost or corrupted, you can use Azure SQL Database. This is a high-grade, secure "digital filing cabinet." It allows you to store thousands of records—like fire extinguisher locations or inspection dates—and retrieve them instantly through an app or a dashboard.

4. Cloud Storage & Data Backup

Azure credits can be used for Blob Storage, which is a secure place to save large files. For a SHERQ company, this is perfect for:

- Storing high-resolution site inspection photos.
- Archiving PDF safety certificates and compliance documents.
- Backing up your marketing videos and content calendars so they are never lost.

STRICT LIMITATION:

No Microsoft 365 or Licenses

It is a common misconception, but Azure credits cannot be used to buy or manage Microsoft 365 licenses.

- No Outlook/Office: You cannot use these credits to pay for email hosting (Outlook), Word, Excel, or PowerPoint subscriptions.
- No Software Licenses: You cannot use credits to buy "standalone" software licenses or manage existing Microsoft "packages."
- Separate Billing: These office tools are part of the Microsoft 365 ecosystem, while your credits are strictly for Azure (infrastructure and cloud building tools). You will still need to pay for your team's email and Office seats separately.